



# The Repair Sheet

*A sheet a student fills in with you after something has gone wrong: what happened, what they were thinking, who it landed on, what they would do differently and what they are going to say. It takes about ten minutes in a one-to-one, one sheet per student, and there is a page for you with the four things that make it work and what to say when the answer is that they do not know. It is not a punishment exercise and it does not replace a sanction. It asks for accountability, which is a different thing from being sorry.*

**Before you start.** Say before the sheet comes out whether a sanction is already happening, and whether anybody else is going to see what they write. A student who thinks the sheet decides their punishment will write it to get out of trouble. Anything on it that is a safeguarding matter goes to your designated safeguarding lead the same day through your school's own system, and you tell the student that you are doing it.

## Print these

| Page   | What it is                                               |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Page 2 | The repair sheet. One per student, per conversation.     |
| Page 3 | The page for you. Print it once and keep it in a drawer. |

## How it works

| Step   | What happens                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Before | Find ten minutes that is not break duty, and somewhere the rest of the form cannot hear. Say what the sheet is for and what happens to it afterwards.         |
| 1      | They fill it in while you are sitting with them. Do not hand it over and come back; the conversation is the resource and the sheet is what holds it together. |
| 2      | Read question 1 back to them in your own words and ask whether you have got it right. It is the fastest way to find the bit they left out.                    |
| 3      | Question 3 is where it either works or does not. Keep going until they name a person, not a rule.                                                             |
| 4      | Finish on questions 5 and 6, and write the date you are coming back to it on the bottom of the sheet in front of them.                                        |

## Worth knowing

- Ten minutes is about right. A conversation that runs to half an hour has usually turned into an interrogation, and the sheet has six questions on it for a reason.
- Do not do this the same hour it happened. Something on the same day is soon enough, and a student who is still angry will write what gets them out of the room.
- If they write one word on every line, that still tells you something. Ask the question out loud and write down what they say.
- Works alongside The Apology, which is the tutor time hour on what an apology has to contain. A form that has had that lesson answers question 5 very differently.

**Agree a date to come back to it, write it on the sheet, and go back on it.**





# The repair sheet

*This is not a punishment, and it does not decide one. It is the ten minutes where we work out what happened and what you are going to do about it. Nobody else reads it unless we agree that somebody will, or unless what is on it means I have to pass it on, and I will tell you first if that happens.*

NAME

DATE

## 1 What happened?

*Start at the beginning, and write what you did rather than what everybody else did.*

## 2 What were you thinking at the time?

## 3 Who else does this land on, and how?

*Anybody who saw it, heard about it, or has to sort it out. Name a person in the left column.*

| WHO | WHAT IT DID TO THEM |
|-----|---------------------|
|     |                     |
|     |                     |
|     |                     |

## 4 If the same thing happened tomorrow, what is the one thing you would do differently?

## 5 What are you going to say, and who to?

TO

WHAT I AM GOING TO SAY

## 6 What do you need from me?

WHAT YOU WILL DO

WHAT I WILL DO

BACK TO THIS ON





# For you, not for them

*Keep this one in a drawer. It is the four things that make the conversation work, and what to say when the sheet comes back blank.*

## Four things that make it work

| The move                           | Why                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ask, do not tell                   | You already know what happened. The sheet is not for finding out, it is for them saying it out loud in their own words.                                      |
| Keep it on the thing that happened | What they did, not what they are like. The moment it becomes a character assessment they stop writing and start defending.                                   |
| Do not use it as the punishment    | If a sanction is going to happen, say so before the sheet comes out and keep the two separate. A sheet that is the punishment gets filled in to be finished. |
| End with something to do           | Question 5 is the one that matters. Somebody is owed something, and knowing what they are going to say is what turns ten minutes into a repair.              |

## When they cannot get started

| They say                            | Try                                                                                                                        |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "I do not know"                     | Go one step earlier. "What were you doing just before it happened?" Nobody is blank about the minute before.               |
| "It was not me"                     | Leave whose fault it was out of it for now. "Tell me what you did, and we will get to the rest."                           |
| "Nothing", on question 3            | Who was in the room? Start with them, then the people who heard about it afterwards.                                       |
| Sorry, straight away                | Take it, then ask what for. An apology that cannot say what it is for has not landed anywhere yet.                         |
| They write what they think you want | Say that you already know that version. Ask what the person it happened to would write if they were doing this sheet.      |
| Silence                             | Wait. Count to ten in your head before you fill it. Most of the time they are deciding whether to be honest, not refusing. |

## Afterwards

**The sheet is theirs.** Give it back to them at the end, or agree together who else is going to see it and why. If something on it is a safeguarding matter, that is not a decision you make with the student in the room: follow your school's own route the same day, and tell them you are doing it. Put the date you agreed in your diary, and go and find them on it even if nothing has gone wrong since.

